

URI SOCIAL

Jane's First Message

Turning a quiet signup into an active user, in one message

**Not a welcome. An offer, from someone who was clearly listening.
Offer first. Create when they say yes. Sound like a friend, not a prompt.**

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1. The Problem We're Solving

Users are signing up but engagement is weak, which drags conversion down. The pattern is familiar: a user signs up, lands in a workspace that feels empty, isn't quite sure what to do first, hits a small moment of friction, and drifts away before they ever feel the product's value.

The single highest-leverage moment to fix this is the very first thing that happens after onboarding. If Jane's first message turns a passive signup into someone who takes one real action, the whole trajectory changes. This document specifies that first message.

THE GOAL

Get the new user to take ONE real action — accept Jane's offer to create something — in the first exchange, so they feel the product working instead of staring at an empty workspace.

2. The Reframe: This Is Not a Welcome Message

A welcome message says 'hi, glad you're here, here's what you can do.' Everyone builds that, and it converts poorly, because it puts the work back on the user: they have to read it, understand it, and then decide to act on their own.

Jane's first message does the opposite. It arrives having already noticed something specific and relevant, and it offers to act on it. The user's only job is to say yes.

Weak (welcome message)	Strong (Jane's first message)
'Welcome! You can create posts, images, and more.'	'[Specific thing] is happening in your world right now — want me to make you a post about it?'
Explains features	Offers a specific, timely action
User must decide what to do	User just says yes
Feels like a product tour	Feels like a friend who spotted something useful

THE ONE-LINE PRINCIPLE

Don't welcome them. Notice something specific about their world, and offer to act on it. Arrive having already paid attention.

3. Offer First, Create When They Say Yes

Decision: Jane OFFERS in the first message, and only GENERATES the content after the user engages. We do not pre-generate a draft for every signup.

3.1 Why Offer-First

- We don't spend generation compute on signups who would never engage anyway
- We don't risk a weak auto-generated draft undercutting the pitch before the user even engages
- The offer creates a small moment of anticipation — the user's 'yes' is them choosing to see what Jane comes up with, which primes them to like it

3.2 What Offer-First Demands

THE MESSAGE CARRIES ALL THE WEIGHT

Because there's no draft to be impressed by yet, the MESSAGE itself has to earn the first tap. The hook must be genuinely specific and timely — a vague 'want me to make you a post?' with no real reason attached is just a feature prompt, and it will be ignored. The specificity of the hook carries the entire conversion.

3.3 The Promise-and-Deliver Risk

The offer sets an expectation. When the user says yes, the content Jane generates MUST deliver on it. If Jane promises 'something great for this trending moment' and then produces something flat, the let-down is sharper than if nothing had been promised. So the generation that follows the yes has to be genuinely good — this is the user's first real impression of the product's output, formed at the exact moment they chose to engage.

4. What the Message Must Contain

Four parts, in this order. Each does a specific job.

4.1 Prove It Was Listening

The first beat references the specific thing the user just entered during onboarding — their business, industry, name. They just finished telling Jane who they are; the first thing Jane says must visibly reflect that, or the illusion of an assistant who knows them breaks in the first sentence.

✓ GOOD *"Saw you're doing custom cakes in Lagos — "*

✗ BAD *"Welcome to your workspace!" (throws away the most valuable thing you have: they just told you who they are)*

4.2 A Genuinely Specific, Timely Hook

The heart of the message. Something specific and relevant happening RIGHT NOW for their kind of business. Specific enough that the user thinks 'that's actually relevant to me,' not 'that's a generic line.' See Section 5 for where the hook comes from.

✓ GOOD *"... and with Valentine's a couple weeks out, cake orders always spike around now."*

✗ BAD *"... content is really important for growing your business." (generic, could be said to anyone)*

4.3 A Low-Effort Offer

End in an offer that's almost no work for the user — a one-tap yes. Jane does everything after that. The user should feel like they're unlocking something effortless, not commissioning a task.

✓ GOOD *"Want me to put together a Valentine's post you can share today?"*

✗ BAD *"You should create content about Valentine's to draw customers and be part of the conversation." (instructive, salesy, and it's asking THEM to do the work)*

4.4 One Clear Next Step

Not a menu. Not 'explore your dashboard.' One obvious tap. The more choices you give a low-engagement user, the more likely they do nothing.

- A single 'Yes, make it' style response, plus an easy way to decline or adjust
- Avoid offering three things at once — one warm invitation to one thing

5. Where the Specific Hook Comes From

The whole message lives or dies on the hook being genuinely specific. Generating that for every industry, every user, on signup day, is the hard part. Three honest sources, in order of strength:

Source	Strength	Reliability
A real current trend / event in their space	Strongest — most impressive	Hardest to generate reliably
Seasonal / calendar relevance for their business type	Strong — genuinely specific	Reliable — always available
A smart evergreen observation about their industry	Weakest — but still real	Always available

5.1 The Recommendation: Seasonal Backbone + Real Trends On Top

BUILD ON THE SEASONAL/CALENDAR LAYER

Use the seasonal/calendar layer as the RELIABLE backbone — what's relevant for this kind of business at this exact time of year. It's genuinely specific, always available, and hard to get wrong (because it IS contextual). Layer real current trends on top when you can source them confidently. That way the message is ALWAYS at least genuinely contextual, never hollow.

5.2 The Nigerian Calendar Is a Gift Here

Nigeria's commercial calendar gives reliable, specific hooks almost year-round: Detty December, Valentine's, Owambe weekends, Independence Day, harmattan (skincare/hair), salary week, back-to-school, Ramadan/Eid, Christmas, Easter, Black Friday. For almost any date, there's a real, specific, timely angle for most business types — which means the seasonal backbone is genuinely strong here, not a fallback.

5.3 The Honesty Rule

If you can't generate something genuinely specific, do NOT fake it with a hollow 'trending in your industry' claim. A fake-specific hook is worse than an honest general one, because it promises intelligence and delivers a mail-merge. Better to say something real and modestly useful than something that sounds personalized but obviously isn't.

6. Tone: A Knowledgeable Friend, Not a Growth Prompt

The target voice: a friend who happens to be great at this stuff, texting because they spotted something useful. Not a platform nudging you toward a metric.

6.1 The Language Test

If a line sounds like a marketing objective, rewrite it as how an actual helpful person would say it.

Sounds like a growth prompt (avoid)	Sounds like a friend (use)
'Create content to draw customers'	'This is perfect timing for you'
'Be part of the conversation'	'Everyone's talking about this right now'
'Boost your engagement'	'This kind of post tends to do really well'
'Start creating content today'	'Want me to put something together?'

6.2 Voice Guidelines

- Warm and casual, the way you'd text someone you like helping
- Short — a couple of sentences, not a paragraph. Long messages feel like work.
- Naturally human: contractions, easy phrasing, a little warmth. Pidgin where the brand/user fits it.
- No jargon, no marketing-speak, no exclamation-mark overload
- Confident but not pushy — offering, not selling
- Never reference metrics, engagement, conversion, or 'growing your business' as objectives — those are OUR goals, not how a friend talks

7. Worked Examples (The Voice Standard)

Concrete first messages for different Nigerian SME types. These are the standard to build against.

7.1 Fashion Vendor (Lagos, Ankara)

Jane Hey Ada! Saw you're doing Ankara pieces in Lagos. Owambe season is picking up and everybody's hunting for standout styles right now — want me to make you a post showing off one of your designs while people are actively looking?

Ada yeah go on

Jane On it — give me a sec. ✨ [generates the post]

7.2 Restaurant / Food (Friday)

Jane Morning! You run the jollof spot, right? Fridays are when Lagos starts planning weekend food, and it's prime time to post. Want me to whip up a quick Friday special post you can put out before the lunch rush?

User how much will it cost

Jane This one's on the house — it's included. Want me to make it?

7.3 Service Business (Interior Decorator)

Jane Hi Tomi! Interior decorator in Lagos — nice. This is the time of year people start planning to redo their space before the festive season, so it's a smart moment to show your work. Want me to put together a post featuring one of your projects?

7.4 Skincare (during Harmattan)

Jane Hey! Saw you do skincare. Harmattan's here and everyone's dealing with dry, ashy skin right now — it's the perfect moment to talk about your products. Want me to draft a post around beating harmattan dryness?

7.5 What NOT To Send

Jane Welcome to URI Social! You can create posts, images, videos and more. Creating content regularly is important to grow your audience and draw customers. Get started by exploring your dashboard!

Why it fails: no proof it listened, no specific/timely hook, instructive and salesy tone, asks the user to do the work, and offers a vague 'explore' instead of one clear action.

8. After the Yes: What Happens Next

The offer worked and the user said yes. Now the generation has to deliver on the anticipation.

1. Acknowledge warmly and briefly ('On it — give me a sec') so it feels responsive
2. Generate the content using everything Jane knows: their business, brand voice/Writing DNA, visual style, and the specific hook from the message
3. The output **MUST** be genuinely good — this is their first real impression, formed at the moment they chose to engage (Section 3.3)
4. Show it for easy approval — one tap to use it, easy to tweak or regenerate
5. Guide the natural next step (publish, schedule, or make another) — gently, one thing at a time

THE MShaping MOMENT

The user went from passive signup to active participant by doing almost nothing but tapping yes. Whether they stay depends on the content that follows landing well. Put real quality into this generation — it's the single most important piece of output in the whole user relationship.

9. If They Don't Say Yes

Not everyone will bite on the first message. Handle it gracefully, not pushily.

- If they ignore it: a single, later, gentle follow-up with a DIFFERENT specific hook (a new angle, not a repeat). Never nag.
- If they decline: acknowledge easily ('No wahala — I'm here whenever you want to make something') and leave the door open
- If they ask a question instead (like pricing): answer simply and warmly, then re-offer once
- Never send the same message twice, and never send more than a small number of these before backing off — a nudge that's always earned stays trusted; one that repeats becomes noise

9.1 Instrument It

Measure not just 'did they open/reply' but the real test: did they end up PUBLISHING something after the first message. That number tells you whether the message is fixing the drift problem — and whether the content after the yes is landing. If users say yes but don't publish, the issue is the generated content, not the message.

10. Summary

10.1 The Message In One Breath

Jane's first message proves she was listening (references what they just set up), delivers a genuinely specific and timely hook (seasonal/calendar backbone plus real trends when available), and ends in a low-effort offer to create something around it. On yes, Jane generates — and that content must be genuinely good, because it's delivering on a promise the user opted into. Warm friend, never growth prompt.

10.2 The Rules

1. Not a welcome — an offer from someone who noticed something specific
2. Offer first, create on yes (don't pre-generate for every signup)
3. The hook must be genuinely specific, or don't claim it's specific
4. Seasonal/calendar backbone + real trends on top
5. Sound like a knowledgeable friend, never a growth prompt
6. One clear, low-effort next step
7. The content after the yes must deliver on the anticipation
8. Measure publishes-after-message, not just replies

Notice something real. Offer to act on it. Sound like a friend.

One good first message turns a quiet signup into an active user.